

Bringing Artifacts to Glean

From zero to nearly 200K weekly active users

Overview

Artifacts was expanding from a new Canvas experience into a broader way to create and shape work in Glean. I took over as sole designer during early development and focused on strengthening the core product as adoption grew.

The work spanned Edit with AI, diff view, Queue Mode, sharing, podcast artifacts and tiles, and launch polish across the editor. Over six months, Canvas grew from zero to nearly 200K weekly active users. ([Actions UX Design Briefs](#); [Artifacts Standup](#))

Team

- Product Manager: Zane Homs
- Engineer: Ihsaan Patel
- Engineer: Mingtao Chen
- Designer: Neel Saswade

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 01]

Final Artifacts experience with Canvas and Edit with AI.

Shaping the core Artifacts experience

The early foundation was in place. The next phase focused on tightening the experience as Artifacts reached more users.

The work covered triggering, editor behavior, direct and chat-based editing, versioning, citations, publishing, and the transition between chat and Canvas. ([Artifacts Roadmap](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 02]

End-to-end flow from prompt to editing, version history, and publishing.

From generated response to editable work

Editability was easy to miss. Revisions often meant returning to chat and describing the relevant section again.

The product needed a tighter loop: select content, describe the change, review it, and keep working in place. ([Canvas editing directions](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 03]

Early Canvas and final editing experience.

Edit where the intent happens

Edit with AI became the main focus.

A contextual toolbar brought AI actions directly to selected content. Edit with AI moved forward, secondary formatting moved into a More menu, and the popover stayed close to the cursor. ([Canvas editing directions](#); [Editing polish notes](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 04]

Selection, custom instruction, and generated edit.

Custom prompts became the main path

Of 1.79 million document artifacts, 475K were edited and 36.5K used Edit with AI. Custom prompts drove 81% of usage. ([Edit with AI metrics](#))

That signal led to a more prominent open input, with presets kept as shortcuts. The document-editing release was delayed to include the stronger entry point. ([Artifacts Standup](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 05]

Usage funnel paired with the redesigned input.

Make every change legible

Diff view made AI edits reviewable in context. Users could inspect additions and removals before accepting the result, with undo as a recovery path. ([Canvas editing directions](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 06]

Diff view with accept and undo controls.

Queue changes, then apply them together

Queue Mode let users mark up several sections before asking Assistant to revise the document. Inline comments collected the feedback, and Apply All resolved it in one coherent pass. ([Queued edits for Documents in Canvas](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 07]

Several queued comments followed by Apply All.

Bringing audio into Artifacts

Podcast artifacts extended the system into audio. The full artifact supported listening, while podcast tiles created a compact form for discovery and return visits. ([Podcast concept](#); [Podcast Canvas proposal](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 08]

Podcast artifact and compact podcast tiles.

Making artifacts easier to share

Artifacts sharing clarified what was being shared, who already had access, and who was suggested. The pattern used a collapsed participant list, clearer permission language, and a reusable modal structure for future collaboration flows. ([Artifact sharing design jam](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 09]

Share dialog with access, suggested participants, and general permissions.

The details that made it shippable

Launch polish covered lockout states, autosave, streaming feedback, responsive layouts, readable titles, and stable in-chat cards. These details helped Canvas feel dependable during everyday use. ([Artifacts Roadmap](#))

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 10]

Lockout, autosave, streaming, and responsive states.

The impact

Canvas reached nearly 200K weekly active users within six months. A high-intent view later reached about 116K weekly active users and 15.5% of Glean weekly active users. ([Actions UX Design Briefs](#); [Edit with AI metrics](#))

The work strengthened the core experience, made AI edits easier to request and review, supported batched revisions, improved sharing, and expanded Artifacts into audio.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER 11]

Growth metric paired with a shipped screen.

What came next

The interaction model created room for more formats and workflows. The next phase focused on improving discovery and adapting the experience to each artifact type.

Co-authored with Glean